

Bazaar

This month we have quite a few heavy duty PC components. Enjoy!

**7,800mAh power bank**

Quantum-Hi Tech has brought a huge 7,800mAh power bank at just Rs. 1,490, with 6 months warranty.

ALL ABOUT THAT NAS

Your storage needs are soon going to be a worry and a NAS might be the way to go

Mithun Mohandas

mithun.m@digit.in

There was a time when we thought Google was absolutely nuts for offering Gmail with a gigabyte of space. Moreover, there was a ticker right in your inbox that kept on increasing. So you'd never have to worry about deleting emails, ever! A decade has nearly passed since then and there are plenty of us who worry about overflowing inboxes. We started branching out and opting for multiple services - Flickr for photos, YouTube for videos,

Dropbox for miscellaneous files etc. Like a meerkat you're ever on the lookout for every opportunity that could end up adding a few GBs to your online storage capacity. It wasn't long before enterprise storage solutions like NAS came to mind. Well, they aren't enterprise anymore.

If you're a little techsavvy then you can put together your own NAS using an old computer and FreeNAS but for everyone else there are plenty of off-the-shelf NAS devices available on the market. We'd have preferred to get a lot more than four devices for this test, unfortunately, this is all that

we could gather in a short time. Hopefully, more NAS devices will come our way in the future.

FOR THE FIRST TIMER

Every single NAS device out there supports basic tasks like having multiple user accounts/groups, auto backup of folders periodically and support multiple filesystems. Budget friendly NAS devices have a CLI (Command Line Interface) but dropping a little extra cash will give you a GUI (Graphical User Interface) which is more suited for the average guy who has been using Windows, OS X

or one of Linux's more popular desktop environments.

The next important thing to keep in mind is that your network configuration goes a long way into making the most out of your NAS device, investing heavily in one while ignoring the other wouldn't be prudent. NAS devices do a lot more than storage these days and more and more manufacturers are offering downloadable packages that extend the functionality of your device. So you could have a simple file sharing setup or you can host an entire website on your NAS. Configuring your NAS to be a web, media, print